PART 11 OF 11 · WHEN TO CALL A PROFESSIONAL

About mold testing

THE SIMPLE VERSION

We do not need a test to know mold is there if we can see it.
The most important job is finding where the water comes from.

If mold growth is visible, sampling is usually unnecessary, and there are no EPA or federal limits for mold spores that a test result can be compared against.[1] CDC does not recommend routine mold testing; it advises removing mold and fixing the moisture problem no matter what type is present.[2]

Where a professional assessment earns its keep is in the questions a swab or air sample cannot answer on its own: **where is the water coming from, how far has it traveled inside the wall or ceiling, and is it still active?** A moisture investigation uses moisture meters, thermal imaging, humidity and dew point readings, and, when needed, targeted inspection openings to locate the source. When sampling is useful, for example to confirm an area was adequately cleaned, it should be designed and interpreted by experienced professionals using AIHA- or ACGIH-recommended methods.[1]

A note on scope

This plan reduces the ways a home can contribute to dust, moisture, and mold exposure. It is general household guidance and not medical advice. Sensitivities differ from person to person, and an allergist can identify which allergens matter most for this household so effort can be focused. These measures work best together: single measures can lower allergen levels without a clear improvement in symptoms, while combined control of humidity, bedding, cleaning, and filtration is the most effective approach.[3] Thresholds in this guide are widely used targets, not guarantees; every building and occupant is different.

When to contact us

- Humidity stays above 55 percent, or dew point stays above about 55°F, despite the AC and a dehumidifier.
- Persistent or recurring musty odors, or condensation at windows, walls, or HVAC supply registers.
- Any water intrusion, including leaks after rain, at storm shutters or sliders, from plumbing, or from the AC drain.
- Visible mold growth, especially more than about 10 square feet or after significant water damage.[1]
- After a remediation, to confirm the work area shows no remaining water damage, mold growth, or mold odor.[4]
- Symptoms continue after these controls are in place. We can discuss whether further building evaluation is appropriate.

Your next step

If any item on the contact list applies to your home, reach out through your client portal and include photos and your recent humidity readings.

Sources for this part

1. EPA, A Brief Guide to Mold, Moisture and Your Home.
https://www.epa.gov/mold/brief-guide-mold-moisture-and-your-home

2. CDC, About Mold.
https://www.cdc.gov/mold-health/about/index.html

3. AAAAI/ACAAI Joint Task Force, Environmental Assessment and Exposure Control of Dust Mites: A Practice Parameter (2013).
https://www.aaaai.org/Aaaai/media/Media-Library-PDFs/Allergist%20Resources/Statements%20and%20Practice%20Parameters/Dustmite-2013.pdf

4. CDC/EPA/FEMA/HUD/NIH, Homeowner's and Renter's Guide to Mold Cleanup After Disasters.
https://www.cdc.gov/mold/pdfs/Homeowners_and_Renters_Guide.pdf